

Python 3 from the Python website. Once you do so you should be able to run Python 3 scripts using the 'python3' command. The 'python' command will still be reserved for the default Python 2 install.

On most Linux distros Python 3 is only available via the 'python3' command while Python 2 is available via the 'python' or 'python2' commands.



On Windows and OSX installing Python also gives you access to a simple Python IDE called IDLE. You may wish to use this to write your code. If you are looking for a more powerful IDE you should check out

PyCharm. It is available in a free and open source community edition that should suit our needs perfectly. There are a number of free IDEs available for Python. There are even a plugins available for Visual Studio and Eclipse if you use one of those.

Basic Syntax

Now that we have Python 3 installed there are two ways we can run Python code. The first is to start the Python interpreter and type commands into it to run them immediately, or you can type all your code into a text file, give it the '.py' extension and then run it with the 'python3' or 'python' command. The content of this section is simple enough for you to just use the interpreter.

As is customary let's start with a simple 'Hello World!' program:

- `print('Hello World!')`

Comments in Python are added using the '#' character. Anything following a '#' character in a line is treated as a comment and not executed.

Variables

In Python creating variables is as simple as giving them a value. So the following are all valid examples of creating variables:

- `my_name = 'Kabir Sharma'`
- `my_age = 11`
- `value_of_pi = 3.1412`

In Python the convention is to use Snake Case, i.e. to use lower case names for variables and functions and separate words using underscores. For constants the convention is to use upper case names separated by underscores.